

mation in the `/proc` is read-only, but there are some files that can be edited to effect immediate changes. Let's leave that to advanced users...

```
kailas@Kailas:~$ cat /proc/cpuinfo
processor       : 0
vendor_id      : GenuineIntel
cpu_family     : 15
model          : 2
model_name     : Intel(R) Pentium(R) 4 Family CPU 2.40GHz
stepping       : 4
cpu MHz        : 2996.696
cache size     : 512 KB
fdiv_bug       : no
hlt_bug        : no
f00f_bug       : no
coma_bug       : no
fpu            : yes
fpu_exception  : yes
cpuid level    : 2
wp             : yes
flags           : fpu vme de pse tsc msr pae mce cx8 apic sep mtrr pge mca cmov
pat pse36 clflush dts acpi mmx fxsr sse sse2 ss ht tm
bogomips       : 4751.36

kailas@Kailas:~$ █
```

CPU information gathered from `/proc`

3.1.2 More about `/proc`

Many files contain simple binary values—0 or 1. Generally, these files simply mean On or Off, and Enable or Disable. By simply changing the value from 0 to 1 or vice versa, the particular behaviour of a device can be altered! Something like the Windows registry? Yes, sort of, but a lot bigger. As this entire file system resides in memory, it is created every time Linux starts. Again, since it is virtual, it has a file size of 0 bytes.

When you view the contents of the `/proc` directories (or the file system, more appropriately), you will see a lot of directories that have numerical names. These are directories containing information about the various processes that have been running at the instant we opened the `/proc` directory. Besides this, you will also find folders pertaining to the devices, chipsets, controllers, etc. For example, if you want to see the features of your CD-ROM drive, all you have to do is type in the following command to view the required details from the `/proc`: “`cat /proc/sys/dev/cdrom/info`”.

The possibilities are endless in seeking information on your system with the `/proc` file system. What we have presented is only

```
kailas@Kailas:~$ cat /proc/meminfo
MemTotal:      248964 kB
MemFree:       17960 kB
Buffers:       1072 kB
Cached:        64052 kB
SwapCached:    3212 kB
Active:        145152 kB
Inactive:      8344 kB
HighTotal:     0 kB
HighFree:      0 kB
LowTotal:      248964 kB
LowFree:       17960 kB
SwapTotal:     722884 kB
SwapFree:      671364 kB
Dirty:         740 kB
Writeback:     0 kB
Mapped:        143488 kB
Slab:          13740 kB
CommitLimit:   847316 kB
Committed_AS: 354720 kB
PageTables:    1432 kB
VmallocTotal:  778232 kB
VmallocUsed:   4356 kB
VmallocChunk:  773748 kB

kailas@Kailas:~$ █
```

Memory usage statistics fetched from `/proc`